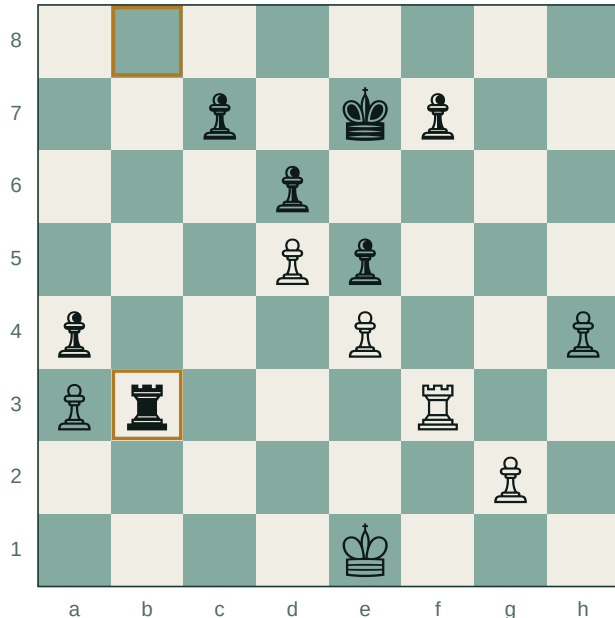


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 43

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 42...Rb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43. Rxb3 axb3 44. Kd2 b2 45. Kc2 b1=R 46. Kxb1

43.Rxb3 The rook captures the rook on b3. Recorded reply: **43...axb3**.

44.Kd2 The king moves from e1 to d2. Recorded reply: **44...b2**.

45.Kc2 The king moves from d2 to c2. Recorded reply: **45...b1=R**.

46.Kxb1 The king captures the rook on b1.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on e7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.